

Civil Services (Main) Qualifying English - Paper B

DETAILED SOLUTIONS / ANSWER KEY | Time: 3 Hours | Maximum Marks: 300

Q1. Essay [100 marks]

Write about 600 words on any one topic.

1. Rules gain legitimacy when they are understandable as well as enforceable.
2. The ability to listen is a form of public responsibility.
3. Progress should enlarge human judgment, not merely human choice.
4. A city is made not only by buildings but by shared habits.

Marking guidance: Marking rubric: relevance and qualified thesis 20; organisation 20; analysis, examples and balance 25; grammar and vocabulary 25; conclusion and approximate 600-word limit 10.

Q2. Comprehension [75 marks]

Public discussion of data often begins with collection: how many records an institution holds and what patterns a computer can detect. Collection is only the first step. Facts become useful when they are accurate, interpreted carefully and connected to a decision for which someone is responsible. A correct record can still answer the wrong question. Attendance does not establish learning, clinic visits do not prove recovery and average traffic speed may hide danger to pedestrians. Numbers simplify reality so that it can be compared; they should not replace the reality they simplify. Good use of data requires judgment about what a measure excludes and what behaviour a target may encourage. This does not justify abandoning measurement. Without records, failure remains invisible and claims cannot be tested. Institutions should combine numerical evidence with observation, explanation and a route for correction. They should publish enough information for scrutiny and revise a measure when it begins to conceal the problem it was designed to reveal.

1. What conditions make collected facts useful?

Model answer: Facts must be accurate, carefully interpreted, connected to a decision and assigned to an accountable decision-maker.

2. How can a correct record answer the wrong question?

Model answer: A measure can be accurate yet fail to represent the intended outcome, as attendance may be counted without measuring learning.

3. What does it mean to say that numbers may replace reality?

Model answer: A simplified indicator may be treated as the complete objective, causing omitted experiences and outcomes to disappear from decisions.

4. Is the author opposed to measurement? Give reasons.

Model answer: No. Records reveal failures and permit testing, but they must be combined with observation, explanation and correction.

5. Give a suitable title and identify the author's tone.

Model answer: A suitable title is 'Using Data with Judgment'. The tone is cautiously supportive rather than hostile or celebratory.

Q3. Precis Writing [75 marks]

Write a precis in about one-third of the passage. Do not give a title.

Silence is often treated as the absence of communication, but in public life it may signify agreement, fear, confusion or exclusion. A chairperson who invites comments and receives none cannot assume that everyone has been heard. Participants may lack technical language, fear disagreeing with a superior or believe that the decision is already final. A formal opportunity to speak is therefore not identical with a fair opportunity to influence an outcome. Listening demands more than waiting politely. It requires asking whether the question was clear, whether relevant people were present, whether another format would permit candour and whether minority reasons were recorded. These steps may slow a decision but prevent avoidable misunderstanding. Listening also has limits: no institution can postpone action until disagreement disappears, and

emergencies may require speed. The aim is not unanimity but the distinction between informed acceptance and silence produced by fear, confusion or exclusion. A public body can then decide firmly while remaining open to correction.

Model answer: Silence does not necessarily imply consent; it may arise from fear, confusion or exclusion. A formal invitation to speak is insufficient when participants lack confidence, language or real influence. Responsible listening checks clarity, representation, safe formats and the recording of minority reasons. Although decisions cannot await unanimity, institutions must distinguish informed acceptance from constrained silence and remain open to correction.

Q4. Usage and Vocabulary [50 marks]

A. Correct the sentences

1. The list of candidates are displayed.

Answer: The list of candidates is displayed.

2. She has lived here since five years.

Answer: She has lived here for five years.

3. He insisted to inspect the file.

Answer: He insisted on inspecting the file.

4. Neither Rohan nor his friends was ready.

Answer: Neither Rohan nor his friends were ready.

5. I prefer walking than driving.

Answer: I prefer walking to driving.

B. Supply the missing preposition or word

1. intended ____

Answer: to

2. familiar ____

Answer: with

3. based ____

Answer: on

4. accused ____

Answer: of

5. different ____

Answer: from

C. Use the correct verb form

1. If the train ____ (leave), we will wait.

Answer: leaves

2. She ____ (prepare) when they arrived.

Answer: was preparing

3. By next June, they ____ (complete) it.

Answer: will have completed

4. Neither answer ____ (seem) sound.

Answer: seems

5. I ____ (not see) him since Monday.

Answer: have not seen

D. Choose the correct word

1. elicit/illicit

Answer: elicit

2. exceed/accede

Answer: exceed

3. credible/credulous

Answer: credible

4. affect/effect

Answer: effect

5. together/altogether

Answer: together

END OF DETAILED SOLUTIONS